UNIVERSITY OF LIBERAL ARTS BANGLADESH (ULAB)

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Culture-

Culture can be defined as all of a population's ways of life, including arts, beliefs, and institutions that are carried down from generation to generation. Culture has been described as "an whole society's way of existence." As such, it comprises etiquette, dress, language, religion, rituals, and art.The expression of one's culture reveals significant aspects of one's identity and value system. We can better comprehend how we are alike and different from one another by appreciating cultural expression.

Culture encompasses all socially transmitted and shared behaviors, manners, customs, rituals, beliefs, ideas, arts, information, values, morals, and ideals that are taught among a group of people of the same nationality, religion, or ethnicity. It is passed down from generation to generation, steadily changing and spawning numerous subcultures in the process.

Cultural variety can make communication challenging, especially in the workplace, where a misunderstanding can lead to significant consequences. When people from various cultures collaborate, several elements can become hurdles. We'll look at these factors first, then dive into how to overcome them as a global team.

1. Language
2. Stereotypes and prejudices
3. Signs and symbols
4. Behaviors and belief
5. “Us” versus “them” (ethnocentrism)

Language

The most important hurdle in cross-cultural contact is the inability to communicate in the same language (well).

Verbal communication is essential in many situations, but the meaning of words can be lost in translation.If one person does not comprehend the true meaning of a word, the other may misunderstand or misinterpret it, leading to a conflict of ideas.

Stereotypes and prejudices

Stereotypes are mainly negative images or preconceived conceptions about a given community, group, or culture. The most common reasons for stereotyping include nationality, gender, color, religion, or age.

Signs and symbols

Nonverbal communication, such as signs and symbols, varies from culture to culture and so cannot be relied on in communication. In Bangladesh, for example, the "thumbs up," which is used as a symbol of approval in the Western world, is considered an insult.

Behaviors and belief

Body language, gestures, mindsets, communication, manners, and conventions are all affected by cultural variations, which can lead to misinterpretation. Eye contact, for example, is highly valued in some cultures but considered unfriendly and insulting in others.

“Us” versus “them” (ethnocentrism)

Belonging to a group makes you stronger and more likely to survive in a difficult world from an evolutionary standpoint. Strangers or other groups were considered "the enemy," with whom they competed for food, safety, and territory.

Intercultural Communication skills

Intercultural communication is the practice of communicating and mutually creating meaning across cultures. It functions as a mechanism that allows people from different cultural groups to perceive and make sense of one another, with the goal of hopefully breaking down stereotypes, increasing knowledge of cultural differences, and seeing equal humanity and the complexity of people who are not from the same cultural group. In essence, being exposed to diverse cultures teaches people to accept and appreciate those who are different from them. Breaking down preconceptions and seeing equal humanity is critical when we consider the years of colonization and propaganda that have moulded the brains of many settler-colonial peoples, including Vermonters, into feeling they are superior to others.

First and foremost, intercultural communication is critical since each employee's unique background, life experiences, and skill set influences their work performance. Because of their employees' diverse perspectives, inclusive businesses have been shown to be nearly twice as innovative as other businesses.

Intercultural communication is thus critical in today's global workforce. More and more firms are using a remote work model that allows them to hire top people from all over the world. When assembling a team of employees from all over the world, you must be familiar with and respectful of their cultural and social conventions.

Problem A

From one culture to another culture transformation create lots of confusion but if someone can accept the concept of cultural relativism they can mix and stay in any culture .As like the new weather of 'UK' we will have lots of trouble for culture difference .those are ,

1. Language
2. Stereotypes and prejudices
3. Signs and symbols
4. Behaviors and belief

Language- Basic way of communication is language,UK use English and Bangadesh use bangla for there mother tongue .

Stereotypes and prejudices-Every country has stereotypes, both positive and negative.Americans are clueless about the world.Americans are fascinated with work, and they believe they are entitled to it.On the other hand bangladeshis are excited about world .bangali peoples are lazy and they belive they are ineligible.About prejudices amarican wilde world known for there Racism culture ,and for bangladesh its about gender discrimination.

Signs and symbols-'Thumbs up' This widely recognised sign of approval or agreement in UK and in bangladesh it is actually used as an insult .

'Come here '

This is used in the United Kindom to ask a person to step forward, but in Asia this gesture isn't welcome.

Behaviors and belief-The United Kindom is a secular nation, which means that the state and religious entities are legally separated. The strong notion of religious freedom underpins society, emphasizing people's liberty to worship any faith and not favor one religion over another.Bangladeshi culture is affected by three great religions in that order: Hinduism, Buddhism, and Islam, with Islam having the most pervasive and long-lasting impact.

Ethnocentrism-Ethnocentrism frequently results in inaccurate judgments about the behavior of others based on your own norms, values, and beliefs. In extreme cases, a group of people may perceive another culture as bad or immoral, and as a response, they may strive to convert, often forcibly, the group. their own way of life.A good example of ethnocentrism is the expectation in America to look someone in the eyes when speaking to them. Other non-American cultures, on the other hand, do not expect you to look someone in the eyes when speaking to them. These are two illustrations of cultural relativism.amaricans are so judgmental about life style ,dress ,food and they believe they are best and right about everything .

Cultural relativism - Cultural relativism refers to the practice of not judging a culture according to our own criteria of what is right or wrong, weird or normal. Instead, we should endeavor to understand other groups' cultural behaviors within their own cultural context.amaricans has less practice in Culture relativism .students and foreigners get bulled /Racised .

Cultural Intelligence -The ability to relate to and function effectively in culturally varied contexts is referred to as cultural intelligence. It is the ability to cross boundaries and thrive in different cultures.

People with high cultural intelligence are sensitive to the values, beliefs, and communication methods of people from many cultures. This information enables individuals to relate to others with empathy and understanding. Cultural intelligence, unlike IQ, cannot be measured quantitatively.Intercultural and Cross-cultural communication focusing on Cultural Intelligence.

Intercultural-defines societies in which all cultures are deeply understood and respected . Intercultural communication is concerned with the mutual exchange of ideas and cultural norms, as well as the building of meaningful relationships.. No one is left untouched in an international society because everyone learns and grows together.

Cross-cultural communication-deals with the comparison of different cultures. Differences are known and acknowledged in cross-cultural dialogue, which can result in individual change but not communal transformation. One culture is frequently considered "the norm" in cross-cultural society, and all other cultures are compared or contrasted to the dominant culture.

For adopting a new culture and work comforlty in that position is called cultural intelligence and for that we have to respect others believes and cultural and that is intercultural and using cross culture in positive way to get a good practice and result is cultural intelligence .so Intercultural and Cross-cultural communication focusing on Cultural Intelligence.

Problem B

Chosen city The United States capital city of Washington, DC Compare my Native Bangladesh capital city Dhaka .

Intercultural Communication-Intercultural communication is a type of communication in which information is shared across cultures and social groupings. It depicts the diverse variety of communication procedures and issues that inevitably arise inside an organization comprised of people from various religious, socioeconomic, ethnic, and educational backgrounds. Intercultural communication is an ancient human activity. However, Intercultural Communication as an academic discipline is still in its infancy. Intercultural communication is also known as cross-cultural communication.It is time to acknowledge that our children's true instructors are no longer school teachers and university professors, but rather filmmakers, advertising executives, and pop culture purveyors. People from other countries and cultures act, talk, and experience the world around them in different ways. Many people in international business communication believe that culture influences how people encode signals. Intercultural communication focuses on social characteristics, mental processes, and the cultures of diverse groups of people in addition to language. It also entails learning about the many cultures, languages, and habits of people from other countries.

It is significant today because we have a globally connected economy and our children are growing up in a world with greater cultural diversity. Some may argue that intercultural communication is mostly about what we say, but it is more about how we act.Businesses must be aware of this since comprehending other cultures requires recognizing the differences between their cultures and ours.Misunderstandings, miscommunications, and confrontations are caused by cultural differences. This page is the best example of intercultural communication for business. It provides classes that teach you how different cultures think about things like time management, relationships, and comedy.It also provides you with practical techniques for avoiding typical errors in your international business connections, preventing them from becoming sources of annoyance or even major problems down the road.

Hofstede six dimensions of culture-Hofstede's initial six key dimensions include power distance, uncertainty avoidance, individualism-collectivism, masculinity-femininity, and short vs. long-term orientation.

Power Distance -

Power Distance is defined as the extent to which less powerful members of a country's institutions and organizations expect and accept unequal power distribution. This is the attitude regarding inequality. Dhaka, the capital city of Bangladesh, ranks well in this dimension, with a score of 80. This informs us that people accept a hierarchical structure in which everyone has a place and which requires no more justification. In other words, people in higher positions will always have more authority. There are significant disparities in pay, authority, and respect. In comparison, Washington, DC scored 40, indicating a culture in which people believe inequality should be minimized.

Uncertainty avoidance-

This dimension reveals how a culture handles unknown truths. High-scoring countries are set in their ways, are intolerant of unconventional behavior and ideas, and are resistant to adapt because they are threatened by new ideas or uncertain facts. However, according to Hofstede, this does not entail that people in high uncertainty avoidance cultures do not engage in high risk activities.

Bangladesh's capital Dhaka has a high score on this dimension, with a score of 60. In comparison to Bangladesh, the United States' tolerant society ranks in the middle of the pack. Washington, DC is the capital city of the United States. I got a 46.

Individualism-collectivism-

This dimension relates to the social tie in a society. Individualist and Collectivist societies are the two sorts of societies defined by Hofstede.

In the individualist society self-image is defined in terms of "I". People are only concerned about themselves and their immediate relations. People are self-centered. They lack connection with others who are not close family members. This is a loosely connected social system.
People in collectivist societies live in groups and care for one another based on loyalty. "We" has surpassed "I" as the most used word. In this culture, people look after one another.With a score of 20, Bangladesh's capital city Dhaka is classified as a collectivist society. In comparison, the United States capital city of Washington, DC scored 91, indicating that it is an individualist society.

Masculinity-femininity-

This factor shows a society's competitiveness. A high score (masculine) on this dimension indicates that competition, achievement, and success will drive society, with success defined by the winner/best in field - a value system that begins in school and extends throughout organizational life. This is a value system in which the winners get everything. People will go to any length to shine, often at the expense of others.

The inverse - Feminine culture, on the other hand, says that caring for others and quality of life are the prevailing values in society. A feminine culture is one in which living a good life is regarded as a sign of success and sticking out from the crowd is frowned upon. The main issue here is whether people are motivated by a desire to be the best (masculine) or by a desire to enjoy what they do (feminine).

Bangladesh's capital Dhaka had a score of 55 on this dimension, indicating that it is a masculine society. The capital city of the United States, Washington, DC, scored 62, indicating a slightly more masculine society than Bangladesh.

short vs. long-term orientation-

This dimension illustrates how each civilization maintains some ties to its own past while dealing with present and future concerns, and how societies prioritize these two existential aims differently. -Normative cultures are those with low scores on this scale. Normative civilizations prefer to keep time-honored traditions and conventions while being skeptical of societal change. The pragmatic culture, on the other hand, has higher marks because of their strategy, which encourages thrift and efforts in modern education to prepare for the future.

Bangladesh gets an intermediate score of 47, indicating no significant preference in a pragmatic society.The United States has a low score of 26, indicating that it is focused on the short term.

CONCLUSIONS-

Geert Hofstede's 6-D model explains the basis of cultural differences in values and ideas about job goals. This work yielded the six major variables discussed above: power distance, individuality against collectivism, masculinity versus femininity, uncertainty avoidance, long-term orientation versus short-term normative orientation, and indulgence versus restraint

Every country is unique. Some countries may have comparable, if not identical, results in one area but radically different values in others. This model can help anyone understand people, their beliefs, customer behavior, managing staff, preparing for effective negotiations, and a variety of other circumstances.

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